

A stylized illustration in shades of green and brown. At the top, a figure representing Prometheus is shown in a pained pose, being attacked by a large eagle. Below them, a hand is shown holding a large, decorated jar (Pandora's Jar) with a yellow ribbon tied around its neck. The background is a mix of green and brown tones with some white lines.

Pandora's Jar

Zeus had punished the Titan Prometheus for giving fire to humans, but he was also angry with mortal men for having fire when he had forbidden it.

Zeus went to Hephaestus, god of smiths and a master craftsman, to ask for help. "I want you to assist me in making a female mortal," said Zeus, "just as Prometheus made men." Together, the two gods gathered handfuls of soil and water and sculpted a beautiful lady—this was the first woman.

Zeus named her Pandora, which meant "all gifts."

Zeus next went to Athena. "I want you to dress this woman in fine silks and weave flowers through her hair," he ordered. Once Athena had dressed Pandora, Zeus placed a golden crown on Pandora's brow. It was forged by Hephaestus and made of golden models of all the animals of the world.

Zeus then gave Pandora to Epimetheus, Prometheus's brother, as a bride. Epimetheus did not think to question Zeus's gift and he accepted his new wife gladly.